



# M/J Spanish, Intermediate

COURSE 0708010 • GRADE 8 • TWO SEMESTERS • OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE — FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW

**About this overview.** This document is an example of how the course might be taught. It was drawn from one section of the course as taught this year, and each teacher leans into their own strengths and passions — so scholars may see some variation in activities, projects, and pacing from section to section, and between the live school and On-Demand. The structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

**What this course is:** The second year of middle-school Spanish, where students go from speaking in the present to telling stories across time. Semester 1 completes the present-tense verb system — regular and irregular verbs, stem-changers, *ser/estar*, *saber* vs. *conocer*, and reflexives — through everyday topics like technology, schedules, sports, and clothing. Semester 2 makes the big leap into the **past, future, and conditional tenses**, capped by a year-end test covering five tenses. Along the way, students tour the **entire Spanish-speaking world** country by country and follow a year-long reading thread through Spain's Golden Age history.

## THE YEAR AT A GLANCE (by quarter)

- Q1 Welcome back; alphabet & pronunciation refined; regular & irregular present-tense verbs through technology vocabulary • **pronunciation test, speaking assessment**
- Q2 The Spanish-speaking world (countries, capitals, flags); schedules, sports & clothing; stem-changers, reflexives, *saber/conocer* • **cultural suitcase project, conjugation tests**
- Q3 The preterite (past) tense, regular → irregular, country by country; the “Los enamorados” Golden-Age history reading begins • **50-Verbs-in-VR group project, investigation project**
- Q4 Present progressive, future, conditional & imperfect tenses; Colombia, Panamá, Costa Rica, Honduras & more • **preterite project, final year-end test (5 tenses)**

## CULTURE & PROJECTS

- **Country-by-country tour** — vocabulary sets for nearly every Spanish-speaking nation, from Perú to Puerto Rico.
- **“Los enamorados”** — a 9-part reading through Spain's Golden Age (the Catholic Monarchs, Carlos V, Felipe II).
- **Investigations** — research projects on true stories from the Spanish-speaking world, with oral recordings.
- **VR experiences** — 16 across the year: cultural festivals (La Tomatina, El Colacho), grammar practice, even Bécquer's poetry.

## A TYPICAL WEEK

- **Duolingo** — daily app practice; 5-day streak = full credit (screenshot weekly)
- **Quizlet** sets — the week's grammar topic and/or featured country
- **Conjuguemos** drills for the current verb tense
- **Culture or history reading** (a “Los enamorados” section or country study)
- **Participation self-score** to close the week; VR experience every 2–3 weeks

## TIME COMMITMENT

**≈4 hours per week** (250 minutes — about 50 min/day, M–F)

Duolingo ≈1 hr (spread daily) • Quizlet/Conjuguemos ≈1½ hr • culture, history & VR ≈1 hr • assessments/projects ≈½ hr

*Per-part split is an estimate; the 250-minute weekly total comes from the school's course plan. Project and test weeks may run longer.*

## WHAT STUDENTS NEED

- A computer with access to Canvas
- Free accounts on **Duolingo**, **Quizlet**, and **Conjuguemos**
- A way to record speaking submissions; VR headset for VR experiences (live-school students use VR daily)

**On-Demand (asynchronous):** This overview describes the self-paced experience the course is designed for — students work through lessons on their own schedule with an Optima teacher available for support, feedback, and grading. The one group activity (50 Verbs in VR) can be completed individually on demand.

**Live school:** Students enrolled in the live virtual school take this same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.